Staff Expense Claims Standard Operating Procedure

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Owner	Group Finance Operations	Classification	Internal (Fictional demonstration document)

1 Purpose

This standard operating procedure (SOP) describes how employees of Northbridge Bank (a fictional organisation) submit, approve and receive reimbursement for work-related expense claims, including overseas travel claims.

2 Roles

2.1 Claimant

The claimant is the employee who incurred the expense and submits the claim.

2.2 Approver

The approver is the claimant's direct manager, or the Department Head where the policy requires it. An approver may not approve their own claim.

2.3 Finance Operations

Finance Operations checks approved claims for completeness and processes the reimbursement payment.

3 Claim Procedure

3.1 Step 1 Complete the Claim Form

The claimant completes the electronic claim form in the Expense Portal, selecting the correct expense category and cost centre.

3.2 Step 2 Attach Receipts

The claimant attaches itemised receipts for each expense above $25. Credit card statements alone are not accepted as receipts.

3.3 Step 3 Obtain Approval

The claim is routed automatically to the claimant's direct manager, who must approve or reject it within 5 working days.

3.4 Step 4 Finance Processing

Finance Operations processes approved claims within 10 working days of approval.

3.5 Step 5 Payment

Reimbursements are paid into the employee's salary account with the next monthly payroll cycle.

4 Rejected Claims

A rejected claim may be corrected and resubmitted once, within 14 calendar days of the rejection notice. A claim rejected a second time must be escalated to Finance Operations for review.

5 Records Retention

Finance Operations retains claim records and receipts for 7 years for audit purposes.